

Crime Scene Administration and Management

Collection and Preservation of Evidence



Crime Scene Search Personnel

- Team Leader
- Photographer
- Sketch Preparer
- Evidence Recorder/Custodian
- Evidence Recovery Personnel
- Specialists

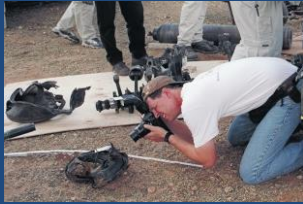


12 Stages of a Crime Scene Search

- Preparation
- Approach scene
- Secure and protect scene
- Initiate preliminary survey
- Evaluate physical evidence possibilities
- Prepare narrative description
- Depict scene photographically
- Prepare diagram/sketch of scene
- Conduct detailed search
- Record & collect physical evidence
- Conduct final survey
- Release scene

7. Depict Scene Photographically

- Records what eyes/brain forgets
- Details are recorded quickly and accurately
- Best way to demonstrate the scene to a jury
- Shows location of evidence
- Begin during preliminary survey
- Use Photo Log for documentation
- Photograph all evidence in place prior to collection



Depict Scene Photographically

- Photograph the scene completely to include:
 - Points of entry/exit
 - Overall, medium, close-up (with and without scale)
 - Surrounding area/neighborhood
 - Victims, crowds, vehicles
- Photographs supplement sketches and notes
- Consider aerial photography

Photographing the Scene

- **Overall**
 - Shows the location of the scene
 - Street signs, etc.
- **Medium**
 - Places the evidence into a location within the scene
 - Shows the relation to the surrounding area
- **Close-up**
 - Close view of each item of evidence (fill the frame)
 - Take with and without a scale
- **NEVER REMOVE EVIDENCE UNTIL IT HAS BEEN PHOTOGRAPHED!!!**



Evidence must be...



photographed in its
original location

POINT OF ENTRY OR OVERALL



POINT OF ENTRY OR OVERALL



POINT OF ENTRY OR OVERALL



OVERALL



MEDIUM RANGE



CLOSE UP (No Scale)



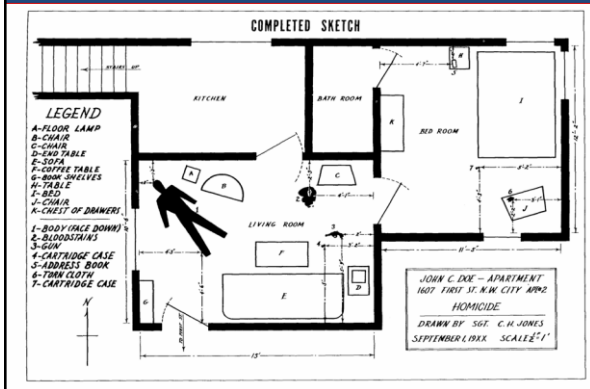
CLOSE UP (With Scale)



8. Sketch, Diagram, or Drawing

- Hand-made pictorial representation of conditions at a crime scene.
- Aids in clarifying investigative data.
- Explains the relative position, appearance and condition of the crime scene and the evidence, which may be important to the case.
- It is an approximation.

Completed Sketch

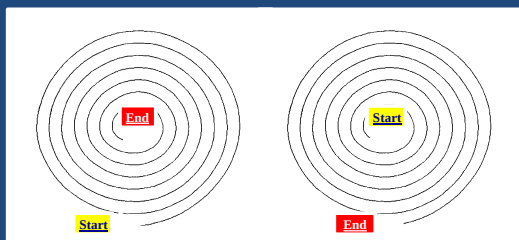


9. Conduct Detailed Search

- Base search method on evaluation of scene
- Conduct search from general to specific
 - Cautious then vigorous
- Use specialized search patterns when necessary
 - Strip, grid, spiral, quadrant, small search teams
- Search entrances and exits
- Wear proper protective equipment to avoid contamination or damaging the evidence
- Obtain known standards
 - Ex: fiber samples from a known carpet
- Slow and methodic – DO NOT RUSH!!!

Crime Scene Search Patterns

CIRCLE OR SPIRAL PATTERN



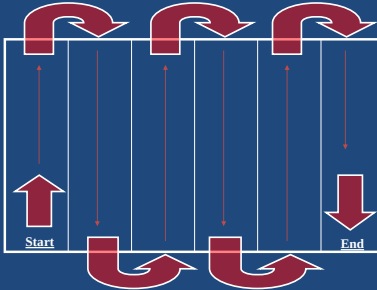
Narrowing Circle

Widening Circle

Crime Scene Search Patterns



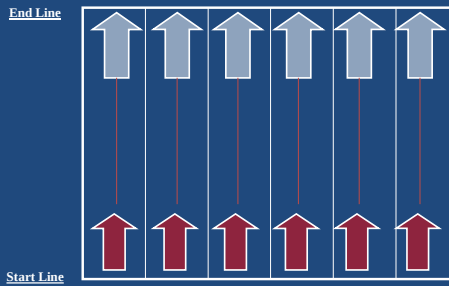
STRIP SEARCH



Crime Scene Search Patterns



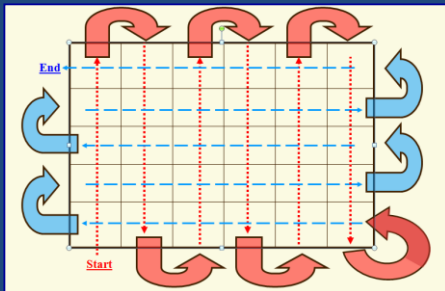
LINE SEARCH



Crime Scene Search Patterns



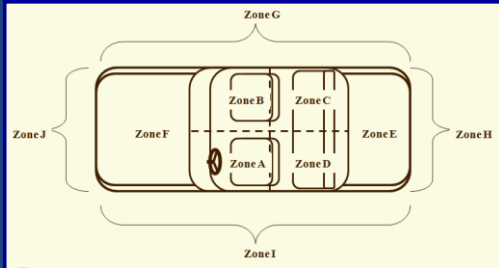
GRID SEARCH



Crime Scene Search Patterns



ZONE SEARCH (Quadrant)



10. Record and Collect Physical Evidence

- Photograph and mark evidence on the sketch
- Complete evidence log
- Have one person as Evidence Custodian, if possible
- Seal the evidence packaging at the scene
- Check all logs and evidence for accuracy
- Have at least two people:
 - Observe the evidence in place before collection
 - Observe the evidence being collected
 - Mark the evidence directly or
 - Mark the evidence containers for identification

Safety Considerations

- Personal safety must always be a consideration
- Consider chemical and biological hazards



Safety Considerations

- Ensure all personnel have personal protective equipment
- Treat all blood and body fluids as infectious
- View crime scene as source of contamination
- Never place hands where you cannot see
- Do not eat, drink, or smoke at crime scenes
- Use face masks and eye protection when dealing with body fluids
- Do not recap hypodermic needles
 - Place directly into sharps container

Locard's Principle of Exchange

- Anywhere you go you leave something behind, and take something away with you
- Good for evidence collection
 - Find evidence of the subject or victim
- Bad for contamination
 - Contaminate the crime scene
 - Residue, hair and fiber, footprints etc.

Contamination Control Techniques

- Wear clean clothing
- Double glove and change gloves often
- DO NOT go from one crime scene to another in the same clothing
- Use shoe covers and remove when you leave the scene
- Explosive residue contamination
 - Do not wear same clothes worn at another post blast scene or residue search
 - Separate evidence from multiple scenes
 - Do not wear firearm while collecting residue samples

Evidence must be packaged and sealed in an appropriate container for the type of evidence collected and for the type of examination that will be required.



Proper Packaging

- Paper
 - Used for biological materials
 - Can destroy latent prints
- Plastic
 - Can cause biological materials to deteriorate
- KPACK Heat Seal Bags
 - Works well for most evidence
 - Don't need to use evidence tape
- Cartons
 - Large items
- Biohazard Material
 - Clearly mark as a biohazard
- Bomb/Arson Evidence
 - Paint cans (must be clean)



Evidence must be packaged and labeled according to Laboratory Policy



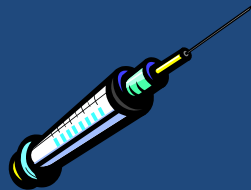
Packaging/Labeling Evidence

- Directly mark evidence when possible
 - Initials and date
 - Be careful not to destroy latent prints
- Mark packaging with administrative info
 - Case number
 - Date
 - Item number
 - Description of evidence
 - Where evidence was found
 - Name and initials of **TWO** personnel who recovered the evidence
 - Consider address of location if multiple scenes
- Seal evidence on site
 - Sign and date across evidence tape

Drug Evidence

Prescription, non-prescription, illegal substances, and drug paraphernalia

- Package separately from other evidence
- Two personnel must weigh/count
- Heat seal in KPAK plastic pouch in the presence of two personnel (or whatever policies apply to your agency)



Valuable Evidence

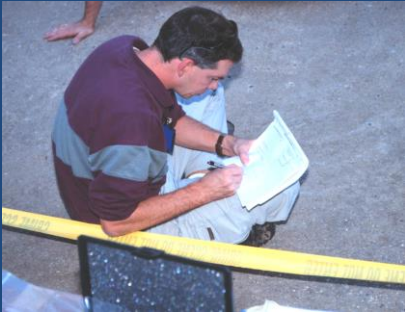
- Money
 - U.S. or foreign
- Jewelry
- Works of Art
- Furs
- Checks
- Negotiable documents
- Credit Cards



Sealing/Packaging Valuable Evidence

- Package separately from other evidence
- Two personnel must count/verify small amounts of money on site
 - Count twice to ensure accuracy
- Bring large amounts to a bank to count
 - Drug investigation
- Heat seal in KPAK pouch
- Package different types of valuables separately

At a scene, evidence should be appropriately listed on an Evidence Recovery Log

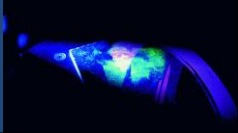


Evidence Log

- Contains the same information as the evidence packaging
 - Description of evidence
 - Where it was found
 - Who found it (two names)
 - Evidence item number
- Information on packaging must match information on evidence log

Documentation

- Chain of Custody
 - 1st signature is the person who collected the evidence
 - Must be diligently maintained – lists all individuals who have had contact with evidence (from collection to court)
 - Remains with the evidence
 - Easiest way for evidence to be suppressed at trial
- NO EVIDENCE – NO CASE!!



11. Conduct Final Survey

- Critical review of all aspects of the search
- Discuss the search jointly with all personnel for completeness
- Double check documentation to detect inadvertent errors or omissions
- Take exit photographs
 - Photograph search warrant in place
- Ensure all evidence is accounted for before departing the scene

Conduct Final Survey

- Collect all equipment prior to departing
- Make sure that nothing has been overlooked and all evidence is collected that could help solve the case
- Make sure appropriate receipts and inventory have been provided as necessary
- Make sure you have utilized all appropriate resources and specialists
- You only have one chance to do it right!

12. Release Scene
